

FAQs

Floppies don't work

Q I have a P-III processor and 128 MB RAM. Of late, I've been facing a problem with my floppy drive—whenever I put in a floppy, it returns a message saying the floppy is not formatted, and then the computer stops responding. I have tried formatting the hard disk. When I scanned the floppy drive with an anti-virus software, it said that the boot record has changed. I checked the BIOS settings, but couldn't figure it out. Please help me.

Rocky Smith

Via e-mail

A Try using a brand new IBM formatted floppy diskette in the drive. If the floppy functions properly, then your previous floppies are either damaged or are infected by virus. However, if the new floppy gives the same error message, then your floppy drive needs professional servicing.

As for the 'boot record has changed' message, it appears if you have enabled the 'virus warning' options in the BIOS. To get rid of it, you will have to disable this option in the BIOS.

Missing boot.ini

Q By mistake I deleted a file named boot.ini from my hard disk. I tried to recover the file with the help of a recovery software, but it was too late. Now when I boot my PC, I get an error saying 'invalid boot.ini file. Booting from c:\winnt\' and then the PC boots normally. Is this a serious problem? So far I haven't faced any problem. I also tried to search for the missing file in the Windows 2000 Professional CD but in vain. Please help me with my problem.

Hitesh Boricha

Via e-mail

A To solve your problem, create a text file in Notepad (or any text editor). Type the following five lines

[boot loader]

Timeout=1

Default=multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\WINNT

[operating systems]

multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\WINNT="Microsoft Windows 2000 Professional" /fastdetect

Save the file by the name, 'boot.ini' in the C: drive. Now you won't face this error anymore.

Problem multibooting

Q I have an assembled computer with a P-III 700 MHz processor and 20 GB hard disk. I had seven partitions—C, D, E, F, G, H and I, plus J as the CD-ROM drive and K as the CD-RW drive. C drive runs Windows 98 and D runs Windows 2000 Professional. I also had Visual Studio.NET and SQL Server 2000 installed in G under Windows 2000 and everything was working fine. The problem began when I installed Red Hat Linux 7.3.

Now, booting into Windows 2000 takes about 5 minutes. After booting, whatever I do, whether it is opening My Documents or an application, the machine hangs. It is working fine in the case of Windows 98 and Linux.

I had deleted the H and I partitions to install Linux (creating Linux native and swap partitions), but these drives are still displayed when I open My Computer in Windows 2000—they are not displayed in Windows 98 though.

Bhaskar

Via e-mail

A The reason your system performance has slowed in Windows 2000 is because Explorer is trying to access the deleted H and I drives in the background.

Check whether the drive types of H and I are Swap and Ext or FAT or FAT32. If these partitions use the Swap and Ext file system, then you need to format them through Windows 2000 and reinstall Linux. This time, be careful about the type of partition you create through Linux (it should be FAT or FAT32) and don't forget to delete the partitions before Linux makes new ones for itself.

Here are the steps you need to follow to install Linux the right way: Select 'Manually partition with Disk Druid', then click Next. Select '/dev/hda6', click Delete and confirm by pressing Yes again. Select '/dev/hda7', click Delete and confirm by pressing Yes. Click New and type 'I' for Mount Point. Select ext3 for File System Type and enter the size of the partition. Select the 'Forced to be a primary partition' checkbox.

Select the 'Check for bad sectors' checkbox, click OK. Under New, select Swap as File System Type and enter the size of the partition. Click OK and then continue with the rest of the installation process.

Rear speakers do not work

Q I have a P4-based system with 256 MB RAM and an ASUS SL133 motherboard. I also have an ADCOM four-channel support soundcard. My speakers are Creative Cambridge 4.1. The speakers work fine with Windows 98. The problem is with Windows XP—when I use Winamp and Jukebox 7.0, the two rear speakers do not function and produce only a light buzzing sound. With other software such as Samsung's media player or Windows Media Player, there is no problem. I have tried changing the advanced settings in the control panel to quadraphonic speakers and have even reinstalled Windows XP, but to no avail. Please give me a solution.

S. Ragunath

Via e-mail



Set the keyboard to US

A Since you are facing problems using Winamp in Windows XP, you should install the A3D plugin. Installing the plugin would enable all the speakers and you can hear from all of them. The plug-in is available at <http://classic.winamp.com/plugins/browse.jhtml>. Similarly you could try this for Jukebox 7.0 also.



Send your computing problems to
sos@jasubhai.com or
write to Digit,

D-222/2, Om Sagar, MIDC, Nerul-400 706, and we may answer it here!